SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

24 May 2022 · Shift 3

80 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 20 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 23 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Rahul sings / very sweet / when he is / in a good mood.

(A) very sweet
(B) when he is
(C) in a good mood
(D) Rahul sings

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My grandfather was a farmer and he _____three acres of land.

(A) cultivated
(B) advanced
(C) grown
(D) cultured

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Lose your touch

(A) Doing someone a favour in hopes that the favour will be returned
(B) To be passed from one person to another
(C) Not being as successful as previously
(D) Something being very difficult to find

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. She had resign / from the / post before / he apologised.

(A) She had resign
(B) he apologised
(C) post before
(D) from the

Q.5

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Bafflement

(A) Confusion
(B) Pleasure
(C) Clarity
(D) Cleanliness

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Praise

(A) celebrate
(B) Condemn
(C) hail
(D) Secure

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. We want to divide the expenses “between” the three of us.

(A) at
(B) among
(C) from
(D) for

Q.8

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. At one’s elbow

(A) Next to someone
(B) Far away
(C) Strong grip
(D) Strong bond

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Confront

(A) Mingle
(B) Conceal
(C) Challenge
(D) Scheme

Q.10

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. After / a long and fun-filled day, / the children / slept themselves peacefully.

(A) a long and fun-filled day
(B) slept themselves peacefully
(C) the children
(D) After

Q.11

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Laxuryous
(B) Innocent
(C) Zealous
(D) Judicial

Q.12

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words Geeta is doubtful about getting hired as she is “inexperienced at this job.”

(A) Professional
(B) Expert
(C) Ace
(D) Novice

Q.13

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. a) is credited with saying b) do not dry your feet c) If you want to leave your footprint on the sands of time, d) Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam, former President of India

(A) d,c,a,b
(B) d,a,c,b
(C) c,a,b,d
(D) a,b,c,d,

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The writer declares that _____ children of their childhood is a criminal act.

(A) robbing
(B) robbed
(C) rob
(D) to rob

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Detrimental

(A) Baseless
(B) Harmless
(C) Senseless
(D) Meaningless

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Blow up

(A) To suffice
(B) To live up greatly
(C) To destroy by an explosion
(D) To stand upright

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Dwarf

(A) Measurable
(B) Medium
(C) Tiny
(D) Giant

Q.20

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When we believe that our mind is thinking _____ thoughts at the same time, what actually is happening is that _____ thoughts are _____ in such quick _____ so as to seem simultaneous

(A) homogenous, measurable, unchanging, velocity
(B) challenging, limited, fixed, interruption
(C) multiple, myriad, alternating, succession
(D) uniform, countable, altering, ramification

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Competition is a necessary prospect for (1)_____ individuals with particular qualities, but only those who can (2)_____ their minds to work, work hard every day, and prove themselves will be able to (3)_____ this arduous battle. It's a never-ending race to the finish line, and only those who put in the effort and dedication will make it to the end. The outcome of any exam does not (4)_____ on the last day, during your paper — your success is ensured with every morning that you put in work. Students must be aware of the tough environment they are entering and prepare (5)_____ in order to improve their chances.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) distinguished
(B) distinguishes
(C) distinguishing
(D) distinguish

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Competition is a necessary prospect for (1)_____ individuals with particular qualities, but only those who can (2)_____ their minds to work, work hard every day, and prove themselves will be able to (3)_____ this arduous battle. It's a never-ending race to the finish line, and only those who put in the effort and dedication will make it to the end. The outcome of any exam does not (4)_____ on the last day, during your paper — your success is ensured with every morning that you put in work. Students must be aware of the tough environment they are entering and prepare (5)_____ in order to improve their chances.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) get
(B) divert
(C) made
(D) put

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Competition is a necessary prospect for (1)_____ individuals with particular qualities, but only those who can (2)_____ their minds to work, work hard every day, and prove themselves will be able to (3)_____ this arduous battle. It's a never-ending race to the finish line, and only those who put in the effort and dedication will make it to the end. The outcome of any exam does not (4)_____ on the last day, during your paper — your success is ensured with every morning that you put in work. Students must be aware of the tough environment they are entering and prepare (5)_____ in order to improve their chances.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) overcome
(B) overload
(C) overpaid
(D) overjoyed

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Competition is a necessary prospect for (1)_____ individuals with particular qualities, but only those who can (2)_____ their minds to work, work hard every day, and prove themselves will be able to (3)_____ this arduous battle. It's a never-ending race to the finish line, and only those who put in the effort and dedication will make it to the end. The outcome of any exam does not (4)_____ on the last day, during your paper — your success is ensured with every morning that you put in work. Students must be aware of the tough environment they are entering and prepare (5)_____ in order to improve their chances.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) awake
(B) arise
(C) arrive
(D) abase

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Competition is a necessary prospect for (1)_____ individuals with particular qualities, but only those who can (2)_____ their minds to work, work hard every day, and prove themselves will be able to (3)_____ this arduous battle. It's a never-ending race to the finish line, and only those who put in the effort and dedication will make it to the end. The outcome of any exam does not (4)_____ on the last day, during your paper — your success is ensured with every morning that you put in work. Students must be aware of the tough environment they are entering and prepare (5)_____ in order to improve their chances.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) reluctantly
(B) consequently
(C) accordingly
(D) exponentially

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.1

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 15, 27, 12, ?, 9, 33

(A) 29
(B) 18
(C) 26
(D) 30

Q.2

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 13,14,23,48,97,178,?

(A) 259
(B) 278
(C) 269
(D) 299

Q.4

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row- 3, 43, 4 Second row- 6, 241, 5 Third row- 2, ?, 11 (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) 173
(B) 192
(C) 137
(D) 129

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 16 : 69 :: 24 : ? :: 31 : 144

(A) 109
(B) 121
(C) 116
(D) 105

Q.7

Which letter cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? WFBI, UCWB, SZRU, ?

(A) QWMN
(B) QXNN
(C) QWNN
(D) QXMN

Q.8

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 16:1024
(B) 14:784
(C) 18:1620
(D) 12:576

Q.9

If A denotes '+', B denotes '×', C denotes '–' and D denotes '÷', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? (13 B 9) D 3 A (14 D 7) B 6 C 21 A (32 B 2) = ?

(A) 96
(B) 100
(C) 112
(D) 94

Q.10

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 19, 38, 35, ?, 135, 810

(A) 146
(B) 142
(C) 137
(D) 140

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. NUMBER : UNNYRE :: MOTHER : OMGSRE :: FINGER : ?

(A) IFDHRE
(B) IFGNRE
(C) IFMTRE
(D) IFTMRE

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'ADVISORY' is written as 'BFYMRMOU', and 'CHAMPION' is written as 'DJDQOGLJ'. How will 'DESIGNER' be written in that language?

(A) EGVNFLCN
(B) EGUMFMCN
(C) EGVMFLBN
(D) EGVNFLBN

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 24 : -192 :: -31 : 248 :: -18 : ?

(A) –152
(B) –146
(C) 148
(D) 144

Q.15

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series to make it logically complete? WVE, UTG, SRI, QPK, ?

(A) MON
(B) MNO
(C) NMO
(D) ONM

Q.17

In a certain code language, 'KITCHEN' is written as 'LHUBIDO', and 'HUSBAND' is written as 'ITTABME'. How will 'ELEMENT' be written in that language?

(A) FKFLFMU
(B) FKFLFNU
(C) FJFLGNV
(D) FKGLFNU

Q.18

In a certain code language, “FAMOUS” is written as “AFOMSU”, and “FINGER” is written as “IFGNRE”. How will “INVEST” be written in that language?

(A) NIVETS
(B) NEIVTS
(C) NIEVST
(D) NIEVTS

Q.19

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some butters are honeys. Some honeys are breads. All breads are jams. Conclusions: I.Some jams are honeys. II.All honeys are butters. III.Some jams are butters.

(A) Only conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Only conclusions I and III follow
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.20

If 21st June 2007 was a Thursday, then what was the day of the week on 21st June 2011?

(A) Wednesday
(B) Monday
(C) Sunday
(D) Tuesday

Q.22

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Adequate 2. Adoption 3. Addiction 4. Abduction 5. Advertisement

(A) 4,3,1,2,5
(B) 3,2,4,1,5
(C) 3,1,4,2,5
(D) 4,2,1,3,5

Q.24

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row- 9, 21, 124 Second row- 11, 25, 148 Third row- 17, ?, 220 (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) 34
(B) 30
(C) 35
(D) 37

Q.25

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, EXCEPT one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 361 : 332
(B) 533 : 504
(C) 440 : 411
(D) 520 : 481

Quantitative Aptitude 15 questions

Q.2

The fourth proportional to the numbers 5, 6 and 8 is:

(A) 9.8
(B) 9.6
(C) 9
(D) 9.5

Q.3

To pack a set of books, Gautam got cartons of a certain height that were 48 inches long and 27 inches wide. If the volume of such a carton was 22.5 cubic feet, what was the height of each carton? [Use 1 foot = 12 inches.]

(A) 36 inches
(B) 32.5 inches
(C) 30 inches
(D) 32 inches

Q.4

5 kg of ₹18 per kg wheat is mixed with 2 kg of another type of wheat to get a mixture costing ₹20 per kg. Find the price (per kg) of the costlier wheat.

(A) ₹27
(B) ₹25
(C) ₹29
(D) ₹30

Q.6

In a government scheme, if an electricity bill is paid before the due date, one gets a reduction of 5% on the amount of the bill. By paying the bill before the due date, a person got a reduction of ₹20. The amount of his electricity bill was:

(A) ₹440
(B) ₹400
(C) ₹520
(D) ₹420

Q.7

A shopkeeper earns a profit of 12% on selling a book at 10% discount on the printed price. The ratio of the cost price to the printed price is:

(A) 38 : 55
(B) 45 : 56
(C) 55 : 38
(D) 56 : 45

Q.8

A thief was spotted by a policeman from a distance of 225 metres. When the policeman started the chase, the thief also started running. If the speed of the thief was 11 km/h and that of the policeman was 13 km/h, how far would the thief have run, before the policeman caught up with him?

(A) 1237.5 metres
(B) 1137.5 metres
(C) 1357.5 metres
(D) 1256.5 metres

Q.9

Which of the following is divisible by 3?

(A) 7345932
(B) 5439763
(C) 3642589
(D) 3262735

Q.10

At a certain rate of interest compounded annually, a sum amounts to ₹10,890 in 2 years and to ₹11,979 in 3 years. The sum is:

(A) ₹9,000
(B) ₹8,000
(C) ₹8,500
(D) ₹9,500

Q.13

In a class, there are 39 students and their average weight is 51 kg. If we include the weight of the teacher, then the average weight becomes 51.2 kg. What is the weight of the teacher?

(A) 53 kg
(B) 59 kg
(C) 57 kg
(D) 51 kg

Q.14

A sum of money becomes ₹ 3,364 at a rate of 16% compounded annually for 2 years. The sum of money is:

(A) ₹2,500
(B) ₹1,800
(C) ₹3,800
(D) ₹2,200

Q.15

If the surface area of a sphere is 1386 cm^2, then find the radius of the sphere.

(A) 12.5 cm
(B) 10.5 cm
(C) 10 cm
(D) 12 cm

Q.17

Simplify $(957 + 932)^2 - 4 \times 957 \times 932$.

(A) 576
(B) 676
(C) 529
(D) 625

Q.19

On reducing the marked price of his goods by ₹28, a shopkeeper gains 20%. If the cost price of the article be ₹560 and it is sold at the marked price, what will be the gain per cent?

(A) 30%
(B) 25%
(C) 20%
(D) 15%

Q.21

Avi and Bindu can complete a project in four and twelve hours, respectively. Avi begins project at 5 a.m., and they work alternately for one hour each. When will the project be completed?

(A) 9 a.m.
(B) 11 a.m.
(C) 1 p.m.
(D) 10 a.m.

Q.25

In an election between two candidates, 80% of the eligible voters cast their votes, 5% of the votes cast were declared invalid. A candidate got 10545 votes, which were 75% of the total valid votes. Find the total number of eligible voters.

(A) 17800
(B) 18500
(C) 18250
(D) 18000

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.1
In which year was the National Biodiversity Authority, a statutory autonomous body, established under the Ministry of Environment and Forests, Government of India?

(A) 2006
(B) 2000
(C) 2003
(D) 2010

Q.2
Who won the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award 2021 in Para Shooting discipline?

(A) Avani Lekhara
(B) Manu Bhaker
(C) Gagan Narang
(D) Apurvi Chandela

Q.3
Who among the following won the Tansen Samman 2020?

(A) Manju Mehta
(B) Dalchan Sharma
(C) Ulhas Kashalkar
(D) Satish Vyas

Q.4
The term 'checkmate' is used in which of the following sports?

(A) Hockey
(B) Chess
(C) Cricket
(D) Badminton

Q.5
Who among the following received the Sahitya Akademi Award (Non-fiction) for his book ‘An Era of Darkness’ in 2019?

(A) Shashi Tharoor
(B) Cyrus Mistry
(C) Jerry Pinto
(D) Arun Shourie

Q.6
Shambhu Maharaj was Awarded the Padma Shri for his contribution to which of the following dances in India?

(A) Kathak
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Kuchipudi
(D) Manipuri

Q.8
On 21st January 2022, three states observed their 50th Statehood Day, which of the following is NOT one amongst these three?

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Nagaland
(C) Tripura
(D) Manipur

Q.9
In optics, the refractive index of a substance is described by the formula n = c/v, where c is:

(A) the speed of light in medium
(B) the centre of curvature
(C) the radius of the sphere
(D) the speed of light in vacuum

Q.10
Which of the following fields is not offered by Kalidas Samman?

(A) Classical music
(B) Classical dance
(C) Puppetry
(D) Plastic arts

Q.11
Which is the largest continental shelf in the world?

(A) The shelf of India
(B) The Indian Ocean shelf
(C) The shelf in the Pacific Ocean
(D) The Siberian shelf in the Arctic Ocean

Q.12

For a NBFC- MFI, the maximum variance permitted for individual loans between the minimum and maximum interest rate_____.

(A) cannot exceed 4 per cent
(B) cannot exceed 2 per cent
(C) cannot be less than 2 per cent
(D) cannot be less than 4 per cent

Q.13

Who among the following was the first woman classical dancer in independent India to be nominated as a member to the Rajya Sabha?

(A) Vidyagauri Adkar
(B) Niveditha Arjun
(C) Rukmini Devi Arundale
(D) Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma

Q.14

Which French chemist summarised his experiment in 1806, and proved that the mass ratio of elements in a chemical compound is always the same, regardless of the source of the compound?

(A) Joseph Proust
(B) Robert Boyle
(C) Jacob Berzelius
(D) John Dalton

Q.15

Who among the following is credited with single-handedly making the Santoor a popular classical instrument?

(A) Shiv Kumar Sharma
(B) Bhajan Sopori
(C) Rahul Sharma
(D) Ulhas Bapat

Q.16

“The State shall not discriminate against any citizen on grounds only of religion, race, caste, sex, place of birth or any of them”. This has been incorporated in:

(A) Article 19
(B) Article 23
(C) Article 15
(D) Article 14

Q.17

EM Subramaniam was an exponent of the _____, a musical instrument.

(A) mandolin
(B) guitar
(C) ghatam
(D) pakhawaj

Q.18

Pandit Ravi Shankar, a music legend is famous for which of the following styles of music?

(A) Hindustani classical instrumental
(B) Hindustani classical vocal
(C) Carnatic classical vocal
(D) Carnatic classical instrumental

Q.19

Which of the following is a limestone cave in India?

(A) Undavalli Caves
(B) Varaha Cave
(C) Borra Caves
(D) Bhimbetka Caves

Q.20

Which of the following dancers of Mohiniyattam form of Indian classical dance was given the Devadasi National Award in 2013?

(A) Smitha Rajan
(B) Jayaprabha Menon
(C) Sunanda Nair
(D) Gopika Verma

Q.22

Find the correct chemical formula of nitromethane.

(A) CH_3NO
(B) CH_3NO_2
(C) CH_4NO_2
(D) CH_3NO_3

Q.23

Among the following famous personalities, whose autobiography is 'The Road Ahead'?

(A) Elon Musk
(B) Bill Gates
(C) Jeff Bezos
(D) Cristiano Ronaldo

Q.24

Which of the following is a type of bryophyte that lives in many environments and is characterised by its small, flattened leaves, root-like rhizoids, and peristome?

(A) Funaria
(B) Ulothrix
(C) Cladophora
(D) Ulva

Q.25

Which of the following ministries was held by Dharmendra Pradhan before he became Cabinet Minister of Education, Skill Development and Entrepreneurship in July 2021?

(A) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting and Sports
(B) Ministry of Food Processing Industries
(C) Ministry of Housing and Urban Development
(D) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and Steel

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) very sweet

A verb is modified by an adverb: 'Rahul sings very sweetly'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) cultivated

Land is 'cultivated', that is farmed; crops, not land, are 'grown'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Not being as successful as previously

To 'lose your touch' is to lose a skill you once had, so that you are no longer as successful as before.

Q.4 · Answer (A) She had resign

The past perfect takes the past participle: 'She had resigned'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Confusion

'Bafflement' is the state of being puzzled: 'confusion'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Condemn

To 'praise' is to express approval; to 'condemn' is to express strong disapproval. 'Celebrate' and 'hail' are close to synonyms.

Q.7 · Answer (B) among

'Between' is used of two, 'among' of more than two: 'divide the expenses among the three of us'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Next to someone

'At one's elbow' means very near: next to someone.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Challenge

To 'confront' someone is to face them in a hostile way: to 'challenge' them.

Q.10 · Answer (B) slept themselves peacefully

'Sleep' takes no object, so no reflexive pronoun: 'the children slept peacefully'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Laxuryous

The correct spelling is 'luxurious'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Novice

A novice is a person new to, and inexperienced in, a job or activity.

Q.13 · Answer (B) d,a,c,b

'Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam, former President of India (d) is credited with saying (a) If you want to leave your footprint on the sands of time, (c) do not dry your feet (b).'

Q.15 · Answer (A) robbing

SSC's key gives the gerund 'robbing', the usual way to make an action the subject: 'robbing children of their childhood is a criminal act'. The infinitive 'to rob' is also grammatical there, if more formal; 'rob' and 'robbed' cannot be subjects.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Harmless

'Detrimental' means causing harm; its opposite is 'harmless'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) To destroy by an explosion

To 'blow up' something is to destroy it by an explosion.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Giant

A dwarf is very small; its opposite is a 'giant'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) multiple, myriad, alternating, succession

The mind seems to think 'multiple' thoughts at once, but in fact 'myriad' thoughts are 'alternating' in such quick 'succession' that they seem simultaneous. No other set makes sense in all four blanks.

Q.21 · Answer (C) distinguishing
After the preposition 'for' the verb takes the -ing form: 'for distinguishing individuals with particular qualities'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) put
To 'put one's mind to' something is to give it one's full attention: 'put their minds to work'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) overcome
To 'overcome' a battle is to win through it: 'able to overcome this arduous battle'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) arrive
Success is built every morning; the outcome does not simply 'arrive' on the last day.

Q.25 · Answer (C) accordingly
To prepare 'accordingly' is to prepare in a way that suits the tough environment just mentioned.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (D) 30
Alternate terms: 15, 12, 9 fall by 3, and 27, ?, 33 rise by 3, so ? = 30.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 299
The differences are 1, 9, 25, 49, 81, the squares of 1, 3, 5, 7, 9. The next is $11^2 = 121$: 178 + 121 = 299.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 129
In each row, first^3 + third^2 = middle: $3^3 + 4^2 = 27 + 16 = 43$ and $6^3 + 5^2 = 216 + 25 = 241$. So $2^3 + 11^2 = 8 + 121 = 129$.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 109
Each second number is 5 times the first minus 11: $16 \times 5 - 11 = 69$ and $31 \times 5 - 11 = 144$. So $24 \times 5 - 11 = 109$.

Q.7 · Answer (A) QWMN
The first letters move back 2 (W, U, S, Q), the second back 3 (F, C, Z, W), the third back 5 (B, W, R, M) and the fourth back 7 (I, B, U, N), wrapping round after A: QWMN.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 18:1620
In the others the second number is 4 times the square of the first: $4 \times 16^2 = 1024$, $4 \times 14^2 = 784$, $4 \times 12^2 = 576$. But $4 \times 18^2 = 1296$, not 1620.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 94
Replacing the letters: $(13 \times 9) \div 3 + (14 \div 7) \times 6 - 21 + (32 \times 2) = 39 + 12 - 21 + 64 = 94$.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 140
The terms are multiplied by 2, 4, 6 and reduced by 3, 5 in turn: $19 \times 2 = 38$, $38 - 3 = 35$, $35 \times 4 = 140$, $140 - 5 = 135$, $135 \times 6 = 810$.

Q.11 · Answer (C) IFMTRE
The first two letters swap, the last two swap, and the middle two are replaced by their opposites in the alphabet (M ↔ N, B ↔ Y): NUMBER → UN NY RE. So FINGER → IF MT RE: IFMTRE.

Q.12 · Answer (C) EGVMFLBN
The first four letters move forward 1, 2, 3, 4 and the last four back 1, 2, 3, 4: ADVISORY → BFYM RMOU. So DESIGNER → EGVM FLBN.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 144
Each second number is the first multiplied by −8: $24 \times (-8) = -192$ and $-31 \times (-8) = 248$. So $-18 \times (-8) = 144$.

Q.15 · Answer (D) ONM
The first letters move back 2 (W, U, S, Q, O), the second back 2 (V, T, R, P, N) and the third forward 2 (E, G, I, K, M): ONM.

Q.17 · Answer (A) FKFLFMU
The letters move +1 and −1 alternately: KITCHEN → LHUBIDO and HUSBAND → ITTABME. So ELEMENT → FKFLFMU.

Q.18 · Answer (D) NIEVTS
Each pair of letters is swapped: FA MO US → AF OM SU. So IN VE ST → NI EV TS: NIEVTS.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows
Some honeys are breads and all breads are jams, so some honeys are jams: I follows. Nothing makes all honeys butters (II), and the butters that are honeys need not be the honeys that are breads, so III does not follow.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Tuesday
From 21 June 2007 to 21 June 2011 is four years, one of which (to June 2008) includes 29 February 2008: 3 + 2 = 5 odd days. Thursday + 5 = Tuesday.

Q.22 · Answer (A) 4,3,1,2,5
Abduction (4), Addiction (3), Adequate (1), Adoption (2), Advertisement (5): 'Ab' comes before 'Ad', and among the 'Ad' words the third letters d, e, o, v set the order.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 37
In each row, 4 × (first + middle + 1) = third: 4 × (9 + 21 + 1) = 124 and 4 × (11 + 25 + 1) = 148. So 4 × (17 + ? + 1) = 220 gives ? = 37.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 520 : 481
In the others the first number exceeds the second by 29: 361 − 332, 533 − 504 and 440 − 411. But 520 − 481 = 39.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (B) 9.6
5 : 6 = 8 : x, so x = 6 × 8/5 = 9.6.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 30 inches
22.5 cubic feet = 22.5 × 12^3 = 38,880 cubic inches. Height = 38,880/(48 × 27) = 38,880/1,296 = 30 inches.

Q.4 · Answer (B) ₹25
5 × 18 + 2x = 7 × 20, so 90 + 2x = 140 and x = ₹25 per kg.

Q.6 · Answer (B) ₹400
5% of the bill is ₹20, so the bill was 20 × 100/5 = ₹400.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 45 : 56
Selling price = 0.9 × printed price = 1.12 × cost price, so cost price : printed price = 0.9 : 1.12 = 45 : 56.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 1237.5 metres
The policeman gains 13 − 11 = 2 km/h, so he closes the 225 m gap while the thief covers 225 × 11/2 = 1237.5 metres.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 7345932
A number is divisible by 3 when its digit sum is: 7 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 9 + 3 + 2 = 33. The other digit sums are 37, 37 and 28.

Q.10 · Answer (A) ₹9,000
11,979/10,890 = 1.1, so the rate is 10%. Sum = 10,890/1.1^2 = 10,890/1.21 = ₹9,000.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 59 kg
Teacher's weight = 40 × 51.2 − 39 × 51 = 2,048 − 1,989 = 59 kg.

Q.14 · Answer (A) ₹2,500
Sum = 3,364/1.16^2 = 3,364/1.3456 = ₹2,500.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 10.5 cm
$4\pi r^2 = 1386$, so $r^2 = 1386 \times 7/88 = 110.25$ and $r = 10.5$ cm.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 625
$(a + b)^2 - 4ab = (a - b)^2$, so the value is $(957 - 932)^2 = 25^2 = 625$.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 25%
A 20% gain on ₹560 means selling at ₹672, so the marked price is 672 + 28 = ₹700. Selling at ₹700 gains 140/560 = 25%.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 11 a.m.
Avi does 1/4 and Bindu 1/12 of the project an hour, so each two-hour round does 1/4 + 1/12 = 1/3. Three rounds, 6 hours from 5 a.m., finish it at 11 a.m.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 18500
Valid votes = 10,545/0.75 = 14,060, which is 95% of the 14,800 votes cast; these are 80% of the eligible voters, so there were 18,500.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) 2003
The National Biodiversity Authority was set up in 2003 at Chennai, under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Avani Lekhara
Para shooter Avani Lekhara, gold medallist in the 10 m air rifle at the Tokyo Paralympics, received the Khel Ratna in 2021.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Satish Vyas
Santoor player Pandit Satish Vyas received Madhya Pradesh's Tansen Samman for 2020.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Chess
Checkmate is the chess position in which the king is attacked and cannot escape, which ends the game.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Shashi Tharoor
Shashi Tharoor won the 2019 Sahitya Akademi Award (English) for 'An Era of Darkness', his book on British rule in India.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Kathak
Shambhu Maharaj, of the Lucknow gharana, was a Kathak dancer and guru.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Nagaland
Manipur, Meghalaya and Tripura became full states on 21 January 1972. Nagaland became a state on 1 December 1963.

Q.9 · Answer (D) the speed of light in vacuum
The refractive index is the speed of light in vacuum (c) divided by its speed in the medium (v).

Q.10 · Answer (C) Puppetry
Madhya Pradesh's Kalidas Samman is given for classical music, classical dance, theatre and the plastic arts; puppetry is not one of its fields.

Q.11 · Answer (D) The Siberian shelf in the Arctic Ocean
The Siberian Shelf in the Arctic Ocean is the largest continental shelf in the world.

Q.12 · Answer (A) cannot exceed 4 per cent
RBI's directions for NBFC-MFIs held that the variance between the minimum and maximum interest rate on individual loans cannot exceed 4 per cent.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Rukmini Devi Arundale
Rukmini Devi Arundale, the Bharatanatyam dancer, was nominated to the Rajya Sabha in 1952, the first Indian woman to be nominated to it.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Joseph Proust
Joseph Proust, a French chemist, established the law of definite (constant) proportions. Dalton was English, Boyle Irish and Berzelius Swedish.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Shiv Kumar Sharma
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma brought the santoor, a folk instrument of Kashmir, into Hindustani classical music.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Article 15
Article 15(1) bars the State from discriminating against any citizen on grounds only of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth.

Q.17 · Answer (C) ghatam
E. M. Subramaniam was a Carnatic percussionist who played the ghatam, a clay-pot percussion instrument.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Hindustani classical instrumental
Pandit Ravi Shankar was a sitar player: Hindustani classical instrumental music.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Borra Caves
The Borra Caves in the Ananthagiri Hills of Andhra Pradesh are natural limestone caves. Undavalli and Varaha are rock-cut caves, and Bhimbetka's are sandstone rock shelters.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Jayaprabha Menon
Delhi-based Mohiniyattam dancer Jayaprabha Menon received the Devadasi National Award at the Devadasi National Dance Festival in Bhubaneswar in September 2013.

Q.22 · Answer (B) CH_3NO_2
Nitromethane is methane with one hydrogen replaced by a nitro group ($-NO_2$): CH_3NO_2.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Bill Gates
'The Road Ahead' (1995), on the coming information age, is by Bill Gates.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Funaria
Funaria is a moss, a bryophyte with rhizoids and a peristome round the mouth of its capsule. Ulothrix, Cladophora and Ulva are green algae.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and Steel
Dharmendra Pradhan was Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas from 2014, and of Steel as well from 2019, until the July 2021 reshuffle.

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